

Order to kill DEI puts colleges on defensive

Likely to face more government scrutiny

By Mike Damiano and Hilary Burns
GLOBE STAFF

President Trump's sweeping executive order calling for an end to diversity, equity, and inclusion policies singles out colleges and universities for enforcement, an opening bid to remake higher education institutions that Trump and his allies see as the original source of progressive values they deride.

The order, signed Tuesday, could have wide-ranging implications across higher education as it demands that recipients of federal contracts and grants swear off DEI programs, and threatens investigations of universities with endowments over \$1 billion, which could include many New England institutions such as Harvard University, MIT, and Northeastern University.

The directive may accelerate a rollback of DEI policies already underway. Some corporations have recently abolished their DEI offices. MIT and Harvard's largest academic division last year ended the practice of requiring professors to outline how they would further DEI goals when applying for jobs, although each

DEI, Page A7

Tensions rise for Mass. immigrants

Rumors of raids shake communities, but no sign ICE has changed tactics

By Danny McDonald, Camilo Fonseca, and Giulia McDonnell Nieto del Rio
GLOBE STAFF

The warnings are raging across text chains, on social media, in panicked calls to lawyers: rumors of immigration officers on raids near Boston, federal agents waiting for students at school bus stops in Worcester, an unmarked van in East Boston that looks suspicious.

Although none of those incidents turned out to be true or real, that they set off alarm bells among immigrants in the Boston area underscores the fear and hysteria gripping a community already on edge over President Trump's return



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Michael Kairos (left), at his barbershop in East Boston, said, "Everyone here is panicked."

to office this week riding a wave of anti-immigrant rhetoric that included pledges of mass deportations.

"Everyone here is panicked, everyone is scared," said Michael Kairos, who owns a barbershop on Meridian Street in East Boston. "People come in asking us what to do. And what can I tell them?"

And while panic continues to characterize the mood in cities and towns shaped by immigration, it remained unclear Thursday whether federal authorities had done anything different during the first few days of Trump's new term. Multiple messages left with US Immigration and Customs Enforcement were not returned Thursday, even as images of its agents arresting immigrants, including alleged MS-13 gang members, spread throughout the region.

In East Boston, which has been a beach head

IMMIGRANTS, Page A6

Judge blocks Trump birthright order

Calls attempt to end automatic citizenship 'blatantly unconstitutional'

By Mike Baker and Mattathias Schwartz
NEW YORK TIMES

A federal judge on Thursday temporarily blocked President Trump's executive order to end automatic citizenship for babies born on US soil, dealing the president his first setback as he attempts to upend the nation's immigration laws and reverse decades of precedent.

In a hearing held three days after Trump issued his executive order, a US District Court judge, John C. Coughenour, sided with Washington, Arizona, Illinois, and Oregon, the four states that sued, signing a restraining order that blocks Trump's executive order for 14 days, renewable upon expiration. "This is a blatantly unconstitutional order," he said.

"Frankly," he continued, challenging Trump administration lawyers, "I have difficulty understanding how a member of the bar would state unequivocally that this is a constitutional order. It just boggles my mind."

Trump responded hours later, telling reporters at the White House, "Obviously, we'll appeal it."

BIRTHRIGHT, Page A7

Mass. to get \$108m in new OxyContin settlement

By Chris Serres
GLOBE STAFF

Massachusetts residents who lost relatives to opioid overdoses expressed elation Thursday after the family that built its fortune on the highly addictive painkiller OxyContin agreed to a new deal to pay billions of dollars to communities ravaged by the opioid epidemic, ending a five-year legal saga.

Members of the Sackler family who own OxyContin maker Purdue Pharma, and the company itself, agreed to pay up to \$7.4 billion in a new settlement to lawsuits over the toll of the prescription painkiller. Massachusetts would receive up to \$108 million to support opioid treatment and recovery programs statewide, the state attorney general announced Thursday.

The deal replaces a previous, \$6 billion agreement that was rejected last July by the Supreme Court because it would have protected members of the wealthy Sackler family from civil lawsuits over OxyContin.

Yet it contains a highly unusual condition that benefits the Sackler family, one that raises ethical concerns among legal experts.

States and local governments would set aside about \$800 million from the settlement for the Sacklers to use as a kind of legal defense fund for any further lawsuits they might face, according to a New York Times report

PURDUE, Page A10

A STRUGGLE ON THE STREETS



CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF

It's been a particularly tough week for the area's homeless population, with plummeting temperatures making it difficult for people to get along outside. Above, a woman who was sitting in front of the Park Street Church decided she needed to go to a shelter for the night. A network of outreach teams, shelters, and nonprofits has worked to try to keep people safe. B1.

News startup ruffles feathers in Plymouth

By Aidan Ryan
GLOBE STAFF

It was about as parochial a controversy as you could find — residents in a Plymouth waterfront condo development had taken numerous noise complaints to town officials, one of which listed "public drinking, loud music, cars peeling out," and other indignities.

The Plymouth Independent's December story about the disturbances was one of the dozens it has published each week in the year since it launched its nonprofit endeavor to fill the void left by the contraction of the town's longtime newspaper. But this one touched a nerve.

Town Manager Derek Brindisi was incensed by the story, complaining that one of his quotes was taken out of context and questioning whether his interview was recorded without his consent. He accused the publica-

PLYMOUTH, Page A10

With fighting on hold in the Gaza Strip, masked members of Hamas's military wing drove through the streets, making it clear the group had survived the bombing campaign. A3.

Governor Maura Healey is asking state lawmakers to allow cities and towns to deploy speed cameras to help catch and ticket motorists. B1.

Evolv Technology, a Waltham-based maker of weapon detection systems, is laying off about 40 workers, or 14 percent of its workforce. B5.

"Emilia Pérez," "Wicked," "The Brutalist," "Anora," "Conclave," and "A Complete Unknown" were the most-nominated films for the Oscars. G5.

In its nearly 50-year run, "Saturday Night Live" has had its share of train wrecks. Check out the 15 biggest controversies in the show's history. G1.



Jan. session

Friday: Pleasant. High 30-35. Low 14-19.

Saturday: A little cooler. High 26-31. Low 21-26.

High tide: 6:45 a.m., 7:28 p.m.

Sunrise: 7:05 Sunset: 4:48

Weather and Comics, G6-7. Obituaries, C9.

VOL. 307, NO. 24

Suggested retail price \$4.00



APU GOMES/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

KEEPING IT IN LINE — Firefighters worked Thursday to stop the spread of the Hughes Fire, which broke out Wednesday and quickly charred 16 square miles near Castaic Lake, a recreation area north of Los Angeles. "We had helicopters dropping water until around 3 a.m. That kept it in check," fire spokesperson Jeremy Ruiz said. A2.